

Joshua Gorton

GAME DESIGNER / PROGRAMMER

London, UK · joshua@familygorton.com · joshuagorton.dev · linkedin.com/in/joshua-gorton · generaljdg.itch.io

PROFILE

UK-based gameplay programmer and recent University of Greenwich graduate specialising in Unity, Unreal Engine and C# scripting. Lead Programmer on Whoever Left the Light On, a surreal POV puzzle game shipped to Steam, where I led a team of four programmers within a twelve-person studio. I enjoy the full development process, from early physical prototyping through to analysing user-testing telemetry and optimising final builds. I thrive in collaborative environments and love solving problems to give players a great gameplay experience.

SKILLS

Engines Unity, Unreal Engine

Languages C#, C++, Blueprint visual scripting

Disciplines Gameplay programming, systems design, procedural generation, AI and flocking behaviour, shader programming, physics-based mechanics, level design, GitHub Desktop and Git CLI, repository structure, asset file management

Practice Team leadership, technical documentation, user testing and telemetry analysis, studio production

SELECTED PROJECTS

Whoever Left the Light On - Lead Programmer

2026

Micro Studio · Releasing 30 Sep 2026 on Steam

- Led a team of 4 programmers within a 12-person studio, shipping the game to Steam.
- Designed core game systems, authored technical documentation, and managed team organisation across the full production cycle.
- Owned the team's Git practice: Git Flow branching, repository structure and file-naming conventions across 4 programmers.

Dissertation - Procedural Generation Research

2026

Solo research project · University of Greenwich

- Can Generated Points of Interest Intuitively Communicate Resource Affordances to Players?
- Built a Unity survival game where players sail between procedurally generated islands, testing whether an island's appearance could signal its resource without explicit markers.
- Designed and ran a 32-participant study against a colour-coded control group, then analysed the results.

Guns On Ice - Solo Project

2025

Object-Oriented Programming module · Released on itch.io

- Sole developer - built recoil-based physics and sliding movement mechanics in Unity, fleshed out into a full arcade game.

Day in the Life of a Carrot Farmer - Team Project

2024

University of Greenwich · Released on itch.io

- First joint university project (team of three) - built the player movement and camera, the interaction system, and the power-up system.

CapSize - Board Game, Team of Four

Game Jam

Physical hex-tile prototype

- Contributed to systems design and prototyping, shaping the wager/risk mechanics around chance-based dice rolls and event cards.

The Castle 2D - Solo Project

College

First finished game

- Branching corridors, sword combat, hidden power-ups and boss encounters, told through environmental storytelling with no dialogue.

TECHNICAL DEMOS

Black Hole Shader (Unreal Engine) - real-time gravitational lensing and light distortion, built with Blueprint scripting and mathematics.

Hole in the Wall (Unity) - a flocking-AI simulation where 2D boid agents steer themselves into position to pass through an aperture in an advancing wall.

EDUCATION

BSc (Hons) Games Design and Development (Programming) - 2:1

2026

University of Greenwich

BTEC Extended Diploma in Games Design - D*/D*/D

North Kent College, Dartford

BTEC Creative Media - Distinction

2021

Longfield Academy

OTHER EXPERIENCE

Sous Chef

- Several years leading and working within a fast-paced professional kitchen.
- Developed team leadership, composure under pressure, and coordinating people to tight deadlines – all of which carry directly into studio production.

INTERESTS

PC building and hardware, Chelsea FC, and an avid Elden Ring player.